

MATTHEW K. RIBAR

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Washington University in St. Louis

July 2025 - present

Postdoctoral fellow at the Weidenbaum Center on the Economy, Government, and Public Policy

EDUCATION

Stanford University

2025

Ph.D. in Political Science

- Fields: Comparative Politics, Political Methodology, and International Relations.
- Committee: Jeremy Weinstein (co-chair), David Laitin (co-chair), Avidit Acharya, and James Fearon.
- Dissertation project: Land, Power, and Property Rights: The Political Economy of Land Titling in West Africa.

Stanford University

2022

M.A. in Political Science

College of William & Mary | University of St Andrews

2017

B.A. (International Honors) International Relations, minor in Economics

ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

2025 Matthew K. Ribar. **Land, Power, and Property Rights: The Political Economy of Land Titling in sub-Saharan Africa**. *American Political Science Review* 120 (2): 399-418 [[replication file](#)].

- African Politics Conference Group's 2025 'Best Graduate Student Paper' award.

2025 Rebecca Janssen and Matthew K. Ribar. **Expertise, accuracy, and reputation inflation in the wine market: Evidence from Vivino ratings**. *Journal of Wine Economics* 20(4): 348-370.

2025 Matthew K. Ribar. **Feeding conflict? New data on the impact of humanitarian food aid on civil conflict**. *Journal of Global Security Studies* 10(2) [[replication files](#)].

2017 Matthew K. Ribar. **Keeping Up with the Times: How the Discipline of International Relations Responds to Benchmark Events**. *International Studies Perspectives*, 18(3): 304-322.

- Published as a SAGE Research Methods Case Study [[link](#)].

WORKING PAPERS

1. Belonging, violence, and natural resource governance: experimental evidence from Mali and Niger (with Alma Bezares Calderón, Simon Mercer, and Ifeoluwa M. Olawole) [[link to working paper](#)] **Under review**.

- Conditionally accepted at the *Journal of Peace Research*.

2. Getting to Youths: Development Programming, Conflict Resolution, and Political Violence in Niger (with Kathryn M. Lance, Ryan Sheely, and Ifeoluwa M. Olawole) [[link to working paper](#)] **Under review**.

3. Intra-respondent reliability and enumerator quality in field conjoint experiments [[link to working paper](#)] **Under review**.

- Invited to revise and resubmit at *Political Science Research & Methods*.
- 4. Trust and Betrayal in Wartime: How Ukrainians Evaluate Foreign Support During the Russian Invasion (with Margit Tavits and Carly Wayne) **Under review**.
 - Available upon request.
- 5. When War Hits Home: Conflict Exposure and Domestic Violence in Ukraine (with Margit Tavits and Carly Wayne) **Under review**.
 - Available upon request.
- 6. Land, power, and property rights: Conjoint evidence from Sénégal and Côte d'Ivoire [[link to working paper](#)].
 - Previously published as Structural Transformation and Economic Growth' (STEG) working paper no. 72 [[link to STEG paper](#)].
- 7. Pitfalls and tradeoffs in measuring support for violent extremism: Evidence from Niger and Burkina Faso (with Ryan Sheely and Adam Lichtenheld) [[link to working paper](#)].
- 8. Indirect Rule and the Endurance of Traditional Governance in Africa, prepared for *The Oxford Handbook on Traditional Law & Governance in Africa* (with Joan Ricart-Huguet).

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

9. Attention land predators! Power and Property in Rural West Africa (book manuscript in progress).
10. Social cohesion and exposure to violent conflict: Evidence from a panel survey in Ukraine (with Margit Tavits, and Carly Wayne).
11. Trust Issues: How Citizens Evaluate State Interventions During Armed Conflict (with Ifeoluwa M. Olawole) [[link to pre-analysis plan](#)].
12. Community Acceptance and Reintegration of Ex-Combatants: experimental evidence from the eastern Democratic Republic of the Congo (with Ifeoluwa M. Olawole) [[link to pre-analysis plan](#)].
13. Customary institutions and social cohesion after war (with Margit Tavits) [[link to pre-analysis plan](#)].
14. Land Registration in Côte d'Ivoire: Consolidation of a national, land-owning elite (with Catherine Boone).
15. Inventing custom? Evidence from court records in colonial Senegal (with Joan Ricart-Huguet and Lindsey Pruett).
16. Escaping the Lean Season Trap: Emergency Food Assistance and Household Resilience in the Sahel (with Horace Gninafon, Jordan Kyle, and Philip Roessler) [[link to pre-analysis plan](#)].
17. Historical cash crop production and land tenure formalization (with Philip Roessler).
18. Countering radicalization in Mali through PREVENTS (with Jamila Alaktif, Mamadou Camara, and David Laitin) [[link to pre-analysis plan](#)].

POLICY PUBLICATIONS

19. The Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH) Project in Cabo Verde: Interim Evaluation Report. 2020. Report submitted to the Millennium Challenge Corporation. Washington, DC: Mathematica Policy Research (with Clair Null, Edith Felix, Audrey Moore, Abbie Turiansky, Jane Fortson, Evan Fantozzi, Dara Bernstein, Emma Pottinger, and Loay Hidmi) [[link to paper](#)].
20. Evaluation Design Report for the Liberia Energy Project: Activities 1 and 2. 2018. Report submitted to the Millennium Challenge Corporation. Washington, DC: Mathematica Policy Research (with Candace Miller, Kristine Bos, Ali Protik, Randall Blair, and Paolo Abarcar) [[link to paper](#)].

21. Evaluation of the Irrigation and Water Resource Management Project in Senegal: Interim Report. 2018. Report submitted to the Millennium Challenge Corporation. Washington, DC: Mathematica Policy Research (with Thomas Coen, Sarah Hughes, William Valetta, and Kristen Velyvis) [[link to paper](#)].
22. Implementing the Arms Trade Treaty and the UNPoA: A Guide to Coordinating an Effective Arms Control System. 2018. Sydney: Centre for Armed Violence Reduction (with Laura Spano, Philip Alpers, and Erly Munoz) [[link to paper](#)].
23. Where the World Comes Up Short: Gaps in Civil Society Efforts to Combat the Proliferation of Small Arms. 2016. Melbourne: Pacific Small Arms Action Group.

GRANTS

- 2025 Weidenbaum Center on the Economy, Government, and Public Policy Small Grant (with Margit Tavits) (\$22,727)
- 2025 Reducing Conflict and Improving Performance in the Economy (UK Foreign, Commonwealth, & Development Office) Small Research Grant (£26,350).
- 2023 SurveyCTO Primary Data Collection Research Grant (\$1,000).
- 2023 Stanford King Center for International Development Advanced Grant (\$10,000).
- 2023 Institute for Humane Studies Expense Support (\$ 5,000).
- 2023 Peace Science Society Graduate Student Travel Grant (\$400).
- 2023 Institute for Humane Studies Expense Support (\$ 750).
- 2023 Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (SIEPR) Schultz Research Fellowship (\$ 4,000).
- 2022 Structural Transformation and Economic Growth (UK Foreign, Commonwealth, & Development Office) Ph.D. Research Grant (£24,535).
- 2022 Stanford King Center for International Development Advanced Grant (\$ 10,000).
- 2021 Stanford King Center for International Development Exploratory Grant (\$ 5,000).
- 2021 National Science Foundation Graduate Student Research Fellowship.
- 2014 International Studies Association Student Travel Grant.

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- 2023 Junior Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies
- 2023 Junior Scholar, Carnegie International Policy Scholar Consortium and Network
- 2021 Stanford Center for African Studies Graduate Fellow
- 2025
- 2021 Immigration Policy Lab Graduate Fellow
- 2025
- 2021 Stanford Impact Labs / Immigration Policy Lab Summer Fellow
- 2019 - Stanford University Graduate Fellowship
- 2025
- 2013 Phi Beta Kappa

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026 American Political Science Association.
- 2025 American Political Science Association, Midwest Political Science Association, World Bank Land and Poverty Conference, Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science, University College London Conflict & Change Workshop (**declined**).
- 2024 Midwest Political Science Association, Governance and Local Development Institute Annual Conference, World Bank Land and Poverty Conference, American Political Science Association, Society for Political Methodology (**declined**), African Politics Conference Group Online Colloquium.
- 2023 Peace Science Society; American Political Science Association; Midwest Political Science Association.
- 2022 Midwest Political Science Association; Working Group in African Political Economy Annual Conference.
- 2020 Midwest Political Science Association; Stanford Graduate Student Comparative Workshop.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Introduction to International Relations, with Jim Fearon (2019)
- The Science of Politics, with Jeremy Weinstein and Jonathan Rodden (2021)
- Data Science for Politics, with Alain Schl pfer (2021)

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mathematica Policy Research

Program Associate

Washington, DC

June 2017 - August 2019

Pacific Small Arms Action Group/Center for Armed Violence Reduction

Consultant

Policy and Outreach Associate

Melbourne, Australia

June 2017 - September 2017

May 2016 - September 2016

Teaching, Research, and International Policy Project

Research Assistant

Williamsburg, USA

November 2013 - June 2017

DEPARTMENTAL AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Reviewer: American Political Science Review, American Journal of Political Science
- APSA mentorship program (2022-2025)
- Stanford 'Pathways to Ph.D.' mentor program (2022-2024)
- Departmental cohort representative (2020)